



who then had to talk to Special Secretary (internal security) Raman Srivastava and then go back to individual states. Snub after snub.

"Maybe we shouldn't have gone overboard with the announcements so early," sighs a Board member. The appeal to the states has turned the exercise of staging a cricket event into an opportunity for political point-scoring and muscle-flexing across eight states, (see box) and amongst eight state police chiefs and ministry babus, all fed up of the BCCI constantly flaunting its independence and financial virility. It was never going to be sweet.

Organising an election is not, either. The original force requirement first put forward by the Election Commission for the 2009 general elections is a staggering 21 lakh securitymen. So, factoring in the protection of teams owned by corporate czars to run a business-venture that was a monstrously popular cricket event, was actually asking government for a huge favour, not demanding a fundamental right.

No high-profile cricket match in India can be staged without assistance from the Government and now, requires the deployment

of specialised bomb and anti-terrorist squads. Private security becomes so limited in its scope that a little humility could go a long way. But the IPL really doesn't do humility. "People are thinking with their egos and not their brains," said an industry-watcher.

There is no shortage of egos around the IPL. One of the sub-plots in this tug-of-war between

**VIEWERS STILL
DON'T KNOW ON
WHICH CHANNEL
THE IPL WILL BE
BROADCAST;
(BELOW)
CHIDAMBARAM**

**WITHIN
the BCCI there
is some mystery
as to why the
Home Ministry
had been
approached
instead of
seeking
clearances from
district level
administrations**



AMIT KUMAR